

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Three phases that must remain separate

GHAZNAVID PHASE

c. 990s-1186

frontier war + raids

Punjab / Lahore base

Mahmud != Muizz al-Din != Aibak.

GHURID PHASE

1175-1206

territorial bridgehead

Delhi-doab expansion

DELHI SULTANATE

from 1206

Indian-centred consolidation

Aibak and Iltutmish

MUST REMEMBER: Mahmud's raid-frontier strategy, Muizz al-Din's bridgehead and Aibak-Iltutmish consolidation are distinct phases.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Campaign chronology

963 -> Alp-tigin at Ghazni | 977 -> Sabuktigin
1001 -> Jayapala defeated | 1009 -> Anandapala defeated
1025-26 -> Somnath campaign | 1186 -> Ghurids take Lahore
1191 -> Tarain I, Ghurid defeat | 1192 -> Tarain II, Ghurid victory
1194 -> Chandawar | 1206 -> Muizz al-Din dies
RULE: battlefield victory and durable consolidation are different stages.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Source criticism matrix

AL-UTBI -> Ghaznavid court claims | panegyric; ends before Somnath
AL-BIRUNI -> comparative inquiry | elite textual and regional limits
BAYHAQI -> court and administration | fragmentary survival
HASAN NIZAMI -> early conquest | ornate Aibak-linked legitimation
MINHAJ -> Ghurid-Delhi sequence | written decades later
COINS / INSCRIPTIONS -> titles and local claims | require contextual reading.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: From Samanid service to Ghaznavid rule

SAMANID PERSIANATE COURT

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Turkic military commanders and service networks

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Alp-tigin at Ghazni -> Sabuktigin -> Mahmud

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roads, cavalry, taxation, court culture and frontier warfare

VERDICT: a state-formation process, not an ethnic migration explanation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Hindu Shahi resistance and frontier breach

KABUL / JALALABAD -> PESHAWAR -> SALT RANGE -> PUNJAB

Hindu Shahi strategic depth and fortified corridors

Sabuktigin pressure -> Jayapala 1001 -> Anandapala 1009 -> Nandana

Kashmir 1015 failure -> weather and terrain still constrained Ghaznavids

VERDICT: prolonged resistance preceded a changing Punjab frontier.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Mahmud's campaigns: reach and limits

DURABLE BASE -> Ghazni + Punjab / Lahore

REPEATED TARGETS -> frontier forts, Multan, Mathura-Kanauj and Somnath

METHODS -> campaigning, tribute, plunder, garrisons and local arrangements

LIMITS -> no comparable permanent Ghaznavid Gangetic administration

RULE: repeated deep raids do not equal uniform territorial occupation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Mahmud's motives as a matrix

FISCAL -> movable wealth and military finance

STRATEGIC -> rivals, frontier security and Punjab control

POLITICAL -> prestige and dynastic legitimation

RELIGIOUS -> ghazi and iconoclast rhetoric

CULTURAL -> court patronage and Persianate kingship

VERDICT: motives reinforced one another and varied by campaign.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Somnath and al-Biruni: event versus evidence

SOMNATH EVENT -> later textual layers, memory and political reuse

AL-UTBI -> cannot narrate 1025 because his account ends earlier

AL-BIRUNI -> scholarship on Indian learning, not a neutral social census

MATERIAL / REGIONAL EVIDENCE -> checks court and later literary claims

METHOD: identify date, genre, patron, report, corroboration and limit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Ghaznavid and Ghurid projects compared

GHAZNAVIDS

Punjab bridgehead + raids

Ghazni-Lahore axis

deep campaigns, limited plains

state focus remained westward

LINK: Ghurids displaced the last Ghaznavid at Lahore in 1186.

GHURIDS

staged territorial advance

Multan-Punjab-Delhi-doab axis

commanders, garrisons and vassalage

wider north Indian succession problem

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Tarain I and II

1191 TARAIN I

Ghurid defeat

Rajput capacity demonstrated

no inevitable Turkish success

1192 TARAIN II

Ghurid return and victory

mounted harassment and reserves matter

learning and command alter outcome

AFTERMATH -> occupation remained uneven; forts, rebellions and local deals continued.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Tarain I (1191), Tarain II (1192) and Chandawar (1194) must remain in exact sequence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Battlefield victory to consolidation

VICTORY

- > commander delegation and garrisons
- > vassalage, tribute and negotiated local rule
- > revenue access and route security
- > suppression of rebellions and rival Turkish claims
- > post-1206 Aibak-Iltutmish consolidation

TRAP: Ghurid opening != instantly complete Delhi Sultanate.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Temple attack, plunder, political legitimacy and warfare require case-specific evidence; none proves mass conversion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 02 answer spine

OPEN -> distinguish Ghaznavid raid-base pattern from Ghurid advance

CONTEXT -> Samanids, military service, roads and frontier geography

MAHMUD -> campaigns + motives + Punjab base + limits

GHURIDS -> Lahore, Tarain, Chandawar and delegated occupation

CAUSES -> organisation and contingency, not racial or weapon determinism

SOURCES -> court rhetoric checked by texts, coins and monuments

CLOSE -> conquest opened a process; consolidation remained contested.